Finance, Administration and Economic Development Committee Meeting

Beaufort County, SC

2nd Floor Arthur Horne Building
104 Ribaut Road
Beaufort, SC 29902

Monday, November 17, 2025
2:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/361009

1. Call to Order

Committee Chair Lawson called the meeting to order at 2:15 PM

Present
Committee Chair Mark Lawson
Committee Vice-Chair Logan Cunningham
Committee Member Dawson - Virtual
Ex-Officio Alice Howard - Virtual
Committee Member Joseph Passiment
Committee Member Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Lawrence McElynn - Virtual
Council Member Thomas Retiz - Virtual

Absent
Council Member David Bartholomew

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Committee Chair Lawson led the Pledge of Allegiance.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Committee Chair Lawson stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, seconded by Committee Member Passiment to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Tabernik,

Council Member Brown, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Tabernik, seconded by Committee Member Passiment to approve the minutes from October 20, 2025.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

6. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken.

7. Reports

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/361009

8. Agenda Items

a. Approval to purchase two (2) Type-1 F-450 ambulances intended to replace assets #38346 and #40272 for Beaufort County Emergency Medical Services. **(FISCAL IMPACT: (Fiscal Impact: 5000-10-3500-54000-fleet service account purchase price $371,245 EACH, TOTAL $742,490. Available balance of $2,902,208.24 AS OF 10/17/2025)** - John Robinson, Assistant County Administrator

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member Tabernik to approve the approval to purchase two (2) Type-1 F-450 ambulances intended to replace assets #38346 and #40272 for Beaufort County Emergency Medical Services.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

b. Approval to purchase a Knuckle Boom Truck for Solid Waste and Recycling ($206,736.10) **(FISCAL IMPACT: 5000-10-3500-54000 as of 10/10/2025 $3,123,439.24 is available. This has been budgeted for FY2026.)** - Victoria Hoffman, Solid Wate and Recycling Program Manager, and Bradley Harriott, Public Works Director

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Tabernik, seconded by Committee Member Passiment to approve the approval to purchase a Knuckle Boom Truck for Solid Waste and Recycling ($206,736.10).

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

c. Approval to purchase a Packer Truck (replacement for asset #40073) for Solid Waste and Recycling ($176,582.48) **(FISCAL IMPACT: 5000-10-3500-54000 as of 10/10/2025 $3,123,439.24 is available. This has been budgeted for FY2026.)** - Victoria Hoffman, Solid Wate and Recycling Program Manager, and Bradley Harriott, Public Works Director

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member Tabernik to approve the approval to purchase a Packer Truck (replacement for asset #40073) for Solid Waste and Recycling ($176,582.48).

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

d. Approval to Contract & Purchase Hardware, Software, and Maintenance for Beaufort County Data Center Upgrade **(FISCAL IMPACT: TOTAL PURCHASE — $793,642.88 to be paid from two accounts. Account # 4013-80-1150-54200 has a balance of $654,349 & Account #1000-10-1150-54200 has a balance of $165,547.)** - Shakeeya Polite, IT Director, Adam Phelps, IT Infrastructure Manager, and Jason Cox, Sr. Systems Administrator

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member Tabernik to approve the approval to Contract & Purchase Hardware, Software, and Maintenance for Beaufort County Data Center Upgrade.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

e. A Resolution to approve recommendations to award FY26 Community Services Grant Program funds in the amount of $398,000 to community service organizations **(FISCAL IMPACT: Council appropriated $398,000 in its FY2026 budget for the annual Community Services Grants Program (Public Welfare Subsidies 1000-50-1598-55000))** - Ben Boswell, Director, Human Services Department

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, Seconded by None to Approve.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson (recused himself from Mt. Carmel Baptist Church Med-I-Assist Program), Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Committee Member Tabernik (recused herself from Staying Connected), and Council Member Brown. The motion passed 8:2.

f. A Resolution approving the Beaufort County Economic Development Corporation's use $600,000 of County Site & Jobs Funds for the purchase of land on St. Helena Island for the development of a Gullah Geechee Cultural Center & Entrepreneurial Market. **(FISCAL IMPACT: $600,000. Balance in BCEDC Fund is $3,033,047.)** - John O'Toole, Executive Director, Beaufort County Economic Development Corporation

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve a resolution approving the Beaufort County Economic Development Corporation's use $600,000 of County Site & Jobs Funds for the purchase of land on St. Helena Island for the development of a Gullah Geechee Cultural Center & Entrepreneurial Market.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Passiment, Council Member Glover, and Council Member McElynn.

Voting Nay: Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Tabernik, Council Member Brown, and Council Member Reitz. The motion failed 5:5.

g. Appointment of Council Member Anna Maria Tabernik to the Beaufort Economic Development Corporation Board to fill the County Council Seat. **(FISCAL IMPACT: N/A)** - Octavia Evans, Senior Administrative Specialist

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Ex-Officio Howard to approve the appointment of Council Member Anna Maria Tabernik to the Beaufort County Economic Development Corporation Board to fill the County Council Seat.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

h. Discussion of potential funding sources for USCB's Convocation/Arena **(FISCAL IMPACT: N/A as we are exploring options.)** - Pinky Harriott, Chief Financial Officer

Council directed administration to come up with options for potential funding sources for USCB's Convocation/Arena.

9. Adjournment

Ratified: January 20, 2026